

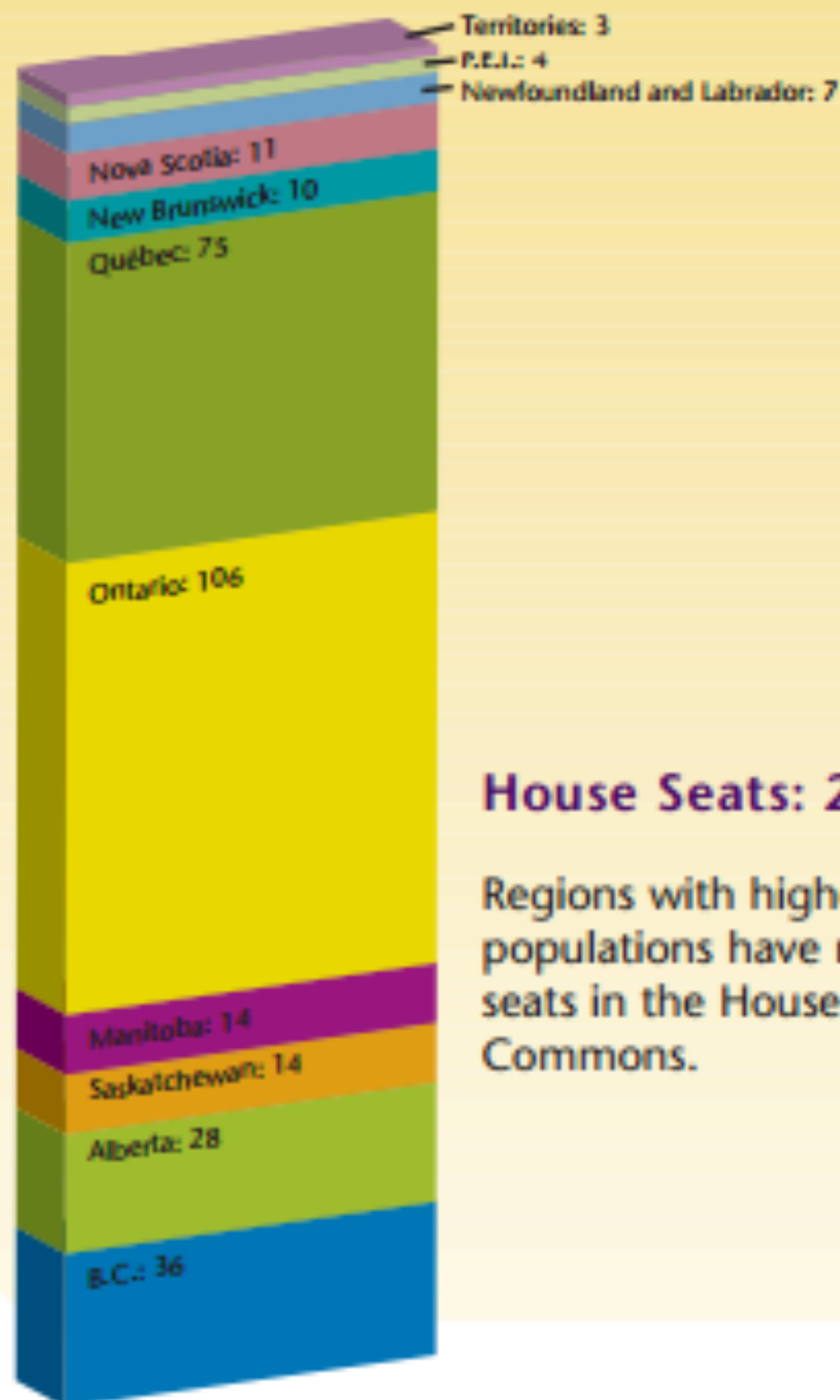




THESENATE

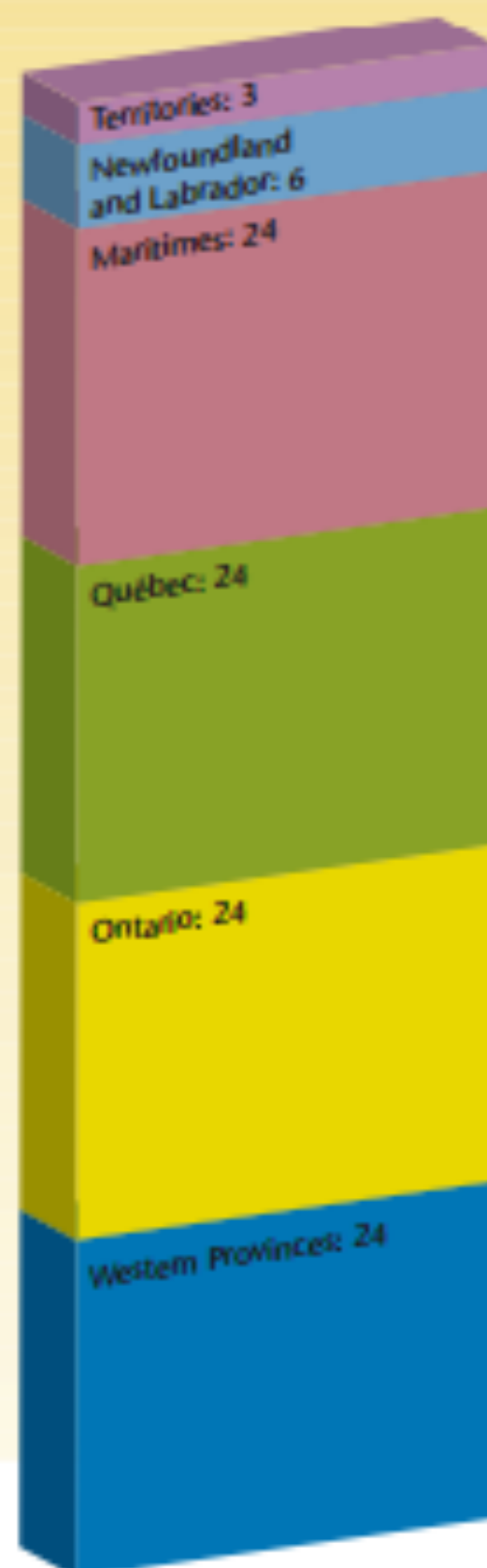
- Senators represent the interests and rights of Canada's regions, and especially Canada's minorities. Senators are appointed by "division," or region. At Confederation in 1867, the constitution identified three regions: the Maritimes, Ontario and Québec. The idea was to ensure that these regions had an equal voice in the Senate, and to ensure that Québec's Francophone population — a minority within Canada — had a strong voice within Canada. As provinces and territories joined Canada, new regions were added to the divisions for appointing senators.
- The Senate can propose laws, but usually only considers bills passed first by the House of Commons. The Senate gives careful reconsideration to all legislation proposed for Canada. This means senators provide a second round of study, debate and voting on laws proposed for Canada. Because the Senate provides a voice for regions in Canada, it brings a different perspective to issues that concern everyone.

REPRESENTATION IN THE HOUSE OF COMMONS VERSUS THE SENATE, 2007



House Seats: 208

Regions with higher populations have more seats in the House of Commons.



Senate Seats: 105

Canada's constitution defines "divisions" — or regions — for appointing senators (see page 31). These divisions have a guaranteed number of seats in the Senate.



How does the structure of the Senate represent Canadians in a different way than the House of Commons? How does this structure help the Senate act in the interests of regions and minority groups?

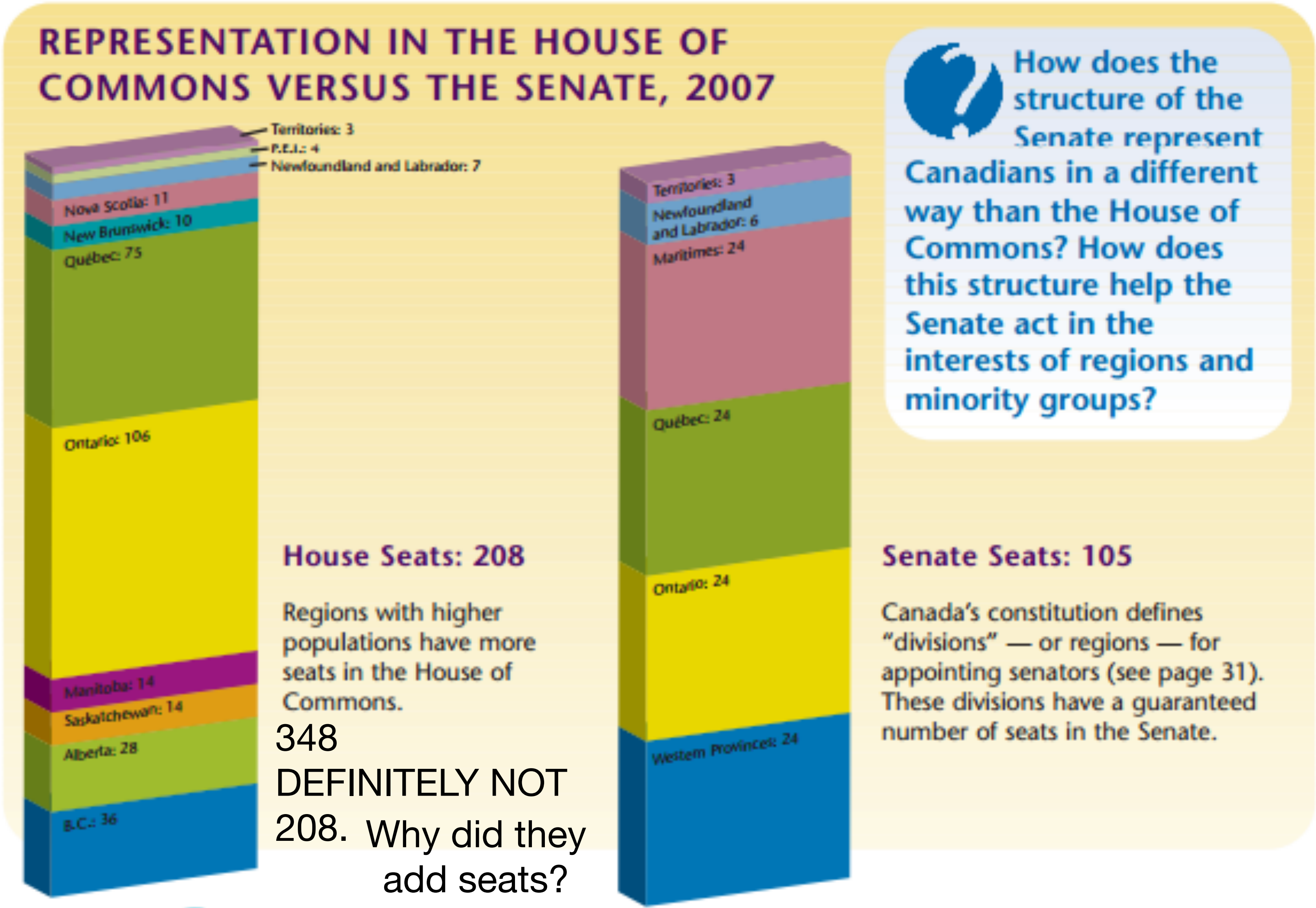
348

DEFINITELY NOT

208.

Why did they
add seats?

THE SENATE



348
DEFINITELY NOT
208. Why did they
add seats?

BILL INTO LAW

